

VIVA QUESTIONS

1. What is Linux?

Linux is an open-source operating system based on Unix.

2. What is a shell?

A shell is a command-line interpreter that allows users to interact with the operating system.

3. What is the command to display the current date and time?

date

4. Which command is used to clear the terminal screen?

clear

5. Which command shows the current logged-in user?

whoami

man

6. What is the purpose of the man command?

It displays the manual page of commands.

7. How do you open the manual page for ls?

man ls

ls, echo, read

8. What does the ls command do?

It lists files and directories.

9. Which option in ls shows hidden files?

ls -a

10. Which option in ls gives detailed information?

ls -l

11. What is the use of the echo command?

It prints text to the terminal.

12. How do you display "Hello" using echo?

echo Hello

13. What is the purpose of the read command?

It takes input from the user.

14. Write a command to read a username from the user.

read username

more, less, cat

15. **What does the cat command do?**
It displays file contents.
 16. **How do you create a file using cat?**
cat > filename
 17. **Difference between more and less?**
less allows both forward and backward navigation, while more mainly allows forward navigation.
 18. **Which command is better for viewing large files?**
less
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cd, mkdir, pwd, find

19. **What does pwd display?**
Present working directory.
 20. **What is the use of cd?**
To change the current directory.
 21. **How do you move to the parent directory?**
cd ..
 22. **What is the command to create a new directory?**
mkdir dirname
 23. **How do you create multiple directories at once?**
mkdir dir1 dir2 dir3
 24. **What is the use of the find command?**
It searches for files and directories.
 25. **Write a command to find a file named test.txt.**
find . -name test.txt
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mv, cp, rm, tar

26. **What does the cp command do?**
Copies files or directories.
27. **How do you copy a.txt to b.txt?**
cp a.txt b.txt
28. **What is the use of mv?**
To move or rename files.

29. How do you rename a file using mv?

`mv old.txt new.txt`

30. What does the rm command do?

Deletes files or directories.

31. Which option removes directories recursively?

`rm -r`

32. What is the purpose of the tar command?

To archive and compress files.

33. How do you create a tar archive?

`tar -cvf file.tar folder`

34. How do you extract a tar archive?

`tar -xvf file.tar`

wc, cut, paste

35. What does wc mean?

Word count.

36. How do you count the number of lines in a file?

`wc -l filename`

37. Which command counts words?

`wc -w filename`

38. What is the use of cut?

To extract specific columns or fields from a file.

39. Write a command to extract the first field separated by :.

`cut -d ":" -f1 filename`

40. What does the paste command do?

It merges lines from files side by side.

head, tail, grep, expr

41. What does the head command display?

The first 10 lines of a file.

42. How do you display the first 5 lines of a file?

`head -5 filename`

43. What does tail display?

The last 10 lines of a file.

44. How do you continuously monitor a log file?

`tail -f logfile`

45. **What is the purpose of grep?**
To search for patterns in files.
46. **How do you search for the word "Linux" in a file?**
grep "Linux" filename
47. **Which option in grep ignores case sensitivity?**
grep -i
48. **What is expr used for?**
Evaluating arithmetic and expressions.
49. **Write a command to add two numbers using expr.**
expr 5 + 3
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chmod, chown

50. **What is the use of chmod?**
To change file permissions.
51. **What does permission 755 mean?**
Owner has full permission; group and others have read and execute permissions.
52. **How do you give execute permission to a file?**
chmod +x filename
53. **What is the purpose of chown?**
To change file ownership.
54. **How do you change the owner of a file?**
chown user filename
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Redirection & Piping

55. **What is output redirection?**
Sending command output to a file.
56. **Which symbol is used for output redirection?**
>
57. **Difference between > and >>?**
> overwrites; >> appends.
58. **What does the pipe operator | do?**
Sends output of one command as input to another.
59. **Give an example of piping.**
ls | wc -l
60. **How do you redirect errors to a file?**
2> error.txt

useradd, usermod, userdel, passwd

- 61. What is the use of useradd?**
To create a new user.
- 62. How do you create a user named john?**
useradd john
- 63. What is the purpose of passwd?**
To set or change a user password.
- 64. How do you set a password for user john?**
passwd john
- 65. What does usermod do?**
Modifies user account details.
- 66. What is the use of userdel?**
Deletes a user account.
- 67. How do you delete a user named john?**
userdel john

Advanced/Tricky Viva Questions

- 68. What is the difference between absolute path and relative path?**
Absolute path starts from root /; relative path starts from current directory.
- 69. What does . represent in Linux?**
Current directory.
- 70. What does .. represent?**
Parent directory.
- 71. What is a hidden file in Linux?**
A file starting with .
- 72. How do you view hidden files?**
ls -a
- 73. Which command combines two commands together?**
Pipe |
- 74. What happens if you run rm -rf /?**
It attempts to delete the entire filesystem.
- 75. Why should rm -rf be used carefully?**
Because deleted files cannot be easily recovered.
- 76. What is the default number of lines shown by head and tail?**
10 lines.

77. How do you search recursively using grep?

grep -r

78. What is the difference between cp and mv?

cp copies files; mv moves files.

One-Word Viva Questions

1. Command to show current directory?

Answer: pwd

2. Command to list files?

Answer: ls

3. Command to change directory?

Answer: cd

4. Command to go to parent directory?

Answer: cd ..

5. Command to create a directory?

Answer: mkdir

6. Command to remove empty directory?

Answer: rmdir

7. Command to delete a file?

Answer: rm

8. Command to copy files?

Answer: cp

9. Command to move/rename files?

Answer: mv

10. Command to create empty file?

Answer: touch

11. Command to display file content?

Answer: cat

12. Command to display first lines?

Answer: head

13. Command to display last lines?

Answer: tail

14. Command to search text?

Answer: grep

15. Command to count words/lines?

Answer: wc

16. Command to clear screen?

Answer: clear

17. Command to print text?

Answer: echo

18. Command to show current user?

Answer: whoami

19. Command to show command history?

Answer: history

20. Command to view manual?

Answer: man

21. Symbol for pipe?

Answer: |

22. Symbol for overwrite redirect?

Answer: >

23. Symbol for append redirect?

Answer: >>

24. Command to change permissions?

Answer: chmod

25. Root directory symbol?

Answer: /

26. Command to search case-insensitive?

Answer: grep -i

27. Command to count only lines?

Answer: wc -l

28. Command to count only words?

Answer: wc -w

29. Command to count only characters?

Answer: `wc -c`

30. Numeric value of read?

Answer: 4

31. Numeric value of write?

Answer: 2

32. Numeric value of execute?

Answer: 1